ADAGIO GROUP

Ezequiel Boero <ezequiel.boero@adagioinstitute.org>

Re: Review #2: Instantaneous Present

ISMAIL-SUTTON, SARA R. <sara.r.ismail-sutton@durham.ac.uk> Wed, Sep 16, 2026 at 10:18 AM
To: "Benjamin D. Summers" <bsummers@adagiollc.com>
Cc: Ezequiel Boero <ezequiel.boero@adagioinstitute.org>

Hi Ben,

Thank you for the detailed response. I have gone through your explanations, as promised.

The revisions you describe in points 1–3 and 5–11 appear to be directed appropriately at the concerns raised in my report. As I have not reviewed the revised manuscript itself, I cannot confirm how fully those points have been resolved in the text, but I do not have any further comments on your descriptions of those changes at this stage.

There are two remaining conceptual points arising from your response.

On point 4, I would be careful with the statement that “any process observed through a finite window is non-Markov at every resolution.” A function or windowed observation of a Markov process is generically, but not invariably, non-Markovian; special sufficient or lumpable transformations can preserve the Markov property. Similarly, the exact calculation for the two-state chain establishes the behaviour of that example, rather than a universal result for all processes. I would therefore retain “generically” and present the nonzero defect and its linear scaling as results for the particular model analysed.

On point 12, I am content for Sections 3 and 4 to be presented as giving positive reasons to question pointwise completeness, provided this remains an interpretative argument. Operational inaccessibility and coincident-point singularities do not, by themselves, establish that a point-indexed state is dynamically incomplete.

Likewise, the claim that the burden of justification lies with a memoryless description can be retained as an argued methodological position, but it does not follow directly from the three physical arguments or from the windowed example alone. A more firmly supported formulation would be that memorylessness should not be presumed without testing its stability under changes in temporal resolution and state-space specification.

Those are the only substantive issues I can identify from the responses themselves. Confirming whether all the revisions have been implemented consistently throughout the manuscript would require a separate review of the revised version.

Best wishes,

Dr Sara Ismail-Sutton

From: Benjamin D. Summers <bsummers@adagiollc.com>
Sent: 07 September 2026 10:12
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Subject: Re: Review #2: Instantaneous Present

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